Nanda Dynasty (c. 345–321 BCE) - Region: Magadha (Bihar), northern India. - Capital: Pataliputra (modern Patna). - Notable Rulers: Mahapadma Nanda. - Religion: Hinduism. - Administration: Strong centralized administration with army and treasury. - Achievements: Built a wealthy and powerful empire; maintained a large standing army; laid the foundation for the Maurya Empire.

Maurya Empire (c. 321–185 BCE) - Region: Northern, central, and parts of southern India; modern Pakistan and Afghanistan. - Capital: Pataliputra. - Notable Rulers: Chandragupta Maurya, Bindusara, Ashoka. - Religion: Hinduism, Buddhism (Ashoka). - Administration: Highly organized with provinces, governors, and spies; centralized taxation. - Achievements: Built roads, forts, and irrigation systems; Ashoka promoted Buddhism and moral governance (Edicts of Ashoka); expanded trade and diplomatic relations.

Shunga Dynasty (c. 185–73 BCE) - Region: Northern India – Magadha, UP, parts of Bengal. - Capital: Pataliputra. - Notable Rulers: Pushyamitra Shunga. - Religion: Hinduism; patronized Brahmanical culture. - Achievements: Strengthened Brahmanical influence; promoted art and architecture (e.g., Sanchi Stupa expansions).

Kanva Dynasty (c. 73–28 BCE) - Region: Magadha, northern India. - Capital: Pataliputra. - Notable Rulers: Susarman. - Achievements: Overthrew Shungas; continued administration and Brahmanical traditions.

Indo-Greek Kingdoms (c. 180 BCE–10 CE) - Region: Northwestern India – Punjab, Sindh, parts of Afghanistan. - Capital: Taxila and other cities. - Notable Rulers: Menander I (Milinda). - Religion: Buddhism. - Achievements: Spread Buddhism to Central Asia; developed Gandhara art; coinage and trade flourished.

Saka (Indo-Scythians) (c. 1st century BCE–4th century CE) - Region: Western and northwestern India – Gujarat, Maharashtra, Rajasthan. - Capital: Ujjain, Taxila. - Achievements: Introduced coins and inscriptions; influenced art and culture; controlled trade routes.

Indo-Parthians (c. 19–226 CE) - Region: Northwestern India – Punjab and Sindh. - Capital: Taxila. - Achievements: Cultural influence from Persia; maintained trade routes.

Satavahana Dynasty (c. 1st century BCE–3rd century CE) - Region: Central and southern India – Maharashtra, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka. - Capital: Pratishthana (Paithan). - Notable Rulers: Gautamiputra Satakarni. - Religion: Hinduism, Buddhism. - Administration: Centralized with local governors. - Achievements: Promoted Buddhist stupas (e.g., Amaravati); developed trade across Indian Ocean; supported art and culture.

Kushana Empire (c. 1st–3rd century CE) - Region: Northern India, Pakistan, Afghanistan. - Capital: Purushapura (Peshawar). - Notable Rulers: Kanishka. - Religion: Buddhism and Hinduism. - Administration: Strong central control; promoted urban trade centers. - Achievements: Supported Buddhism; promoted trade along Silk Road; introduced coinage and artistic developments.

Western Kshatrapas (c. 35–405 CE) - Region: Western India – Gujarat, Maharashtra. - Capital: Ujjain, later Aparanta. - Achievements: Controlled western trade routes; promoted coins, inscriptions, and administration.

Gupta Empire (c. 320–550 CE) - Region: Northern and central India. - Capital: Pataliputra. - Notable Rulers: Chandragupta I, Samudragupta, Chandragupta II. - Religion: Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism. - Achievements: Golden Age of India; advances in literature, art, science, mathematics; strong administration; built temples.

Vakataka Dynasty (c. 250–500 CE) - Region: Deccan – Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh. - Capital: Pravarapura (Paithan). - Notable Rulers: Pravarasena I, Harishena. - Religion: Hinduism, some Buddhism. - Achievements: Supported Ajanta Caves; maintained alliances including with Guptas.

Huna Invasions (Hephthalites) (5th–6th century CE) - Region: Northwestern India – Punjab, Rajasthan, MP. - Impact: Weakened Gupta Empire; introduced cavalry and new military strategies; caused political instability.

Maukharis Dynasty (c. 6th century CE) - Region: Northern India – UP and Magadha. - Capital: Kannauj. - Notable Rulers: Ishanavarman. - Achievements: Resisted Hunas; maintained strong administration.

Maitraka Dynasty (c. 475–767 CE) - Region: Western India – Gujarat. - Capital: Valabhi. - Religion: Hinduism and Buddhism. - Achievements: Center of learning and education; promoted trade and culture.

Gauda Kingdom (7th–8th century CE) - Region: Bengal. - Capital: Karnasubarna. - Notable Rulers: Shashanka. - Achievements: First independent kingdom of Bengal; promoted Buddhism and Hinduism; organized administration.

Harsha Empire (c. 606–647 CE) - Region: Northern India – UP, Bihar, Bengal. - Capital: Kanauj. - Notable Rulers: Harshavardhana. - Religion: Hinduism and Buddhism. - Achievements: United northern India politically; supported literature, art, and religion; maintained diplomatic relations.

Gurjara-Pratihara Empire (c. 8th–11th century CE) - Region: Northern and western India – Rajasthan, MP, UP. - Capital: Kannauj. - Notable Rulers: Nagabhata I, Mihira Bhoja. - Religion: Hinduism. - Achievements: Defended India from Arab invasions; promoted temple architecture; strong feudal administration.

Pala Empire (c. 750–1174 CE) - Region: Bengal and Bihar. - Capital: Pataliputra / Vikramashila. - Notable Rulers: Gopala, Dharmapala, Devapala. - Religion: Buddhism (Mahayana), supported universities. - Achievements: Promoted Buddhist education and art; maintained trade with Southeast Asia; strong administration.

Southern Kingdoms: - Chera Dynasty – Kerala; maritime trade; cultural centers. - Pandya Dynasty – Tamil Nadu; temples; trade in pearls and spices. - Pallava Dynasty – Tamil Nadu; capital Kanchipuram; rock-cut temples; Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram. - Chalukya Dynasty – Karnataka; Badami and Pattadakal temples; promoted art and architecture. - Chola Dynasty – Tamil Nadu; Thanjavur; Brihadeeswarar Temple; strong navy; trade with Southeast Asia.